

DEPART TRAVEL SERVICES

DEPART TRAVEL SERVICES · TUNISIA

TUNISIA

Desert & Berber-highland expedition trekking — prepared for ExpeditionXplore

WHO WE ARE

Depart Travel Services is a licensed Tunisian Destination Management Company (DMC) based on the island of Djerba — and a genuine specialist in **multi-day desert and mountain trekking**. We are not a foreign agency operating from afar; we are a true *local* operator, born and run in Tunisia, with the ground knowledge, relationships and access that only come from walking these routes every season.

Trekking is core to what we do. We field **ONTT-certified mountain and desert guides**, run our own **fully insured fleet with 4x4 support**, organise **camel support caravans** for baggage and water resupply, and back every departure with **genuine 24/7 in-destination support**. Every route we offer is underpinned by **documented risk assessments and safety protocols**, a trained camp crew, satellite-comms options and a clear evacuation plan. For an expedition operator, we are the local partner who turns a line on a map into a safe, well-supplied, point-to-point trek on the ground.

WHY DEPART TRAVEL — FOR EXPEDITIONXPLORE

ExpeditionXplore runs small-group, long-distance trekking expeditions to remote, off-the-beaten-path regions on **fixed departures**, for travellers seeking adventure *and* meaning. Tunisia, delivered through a true local trekking specialist, is exactly that proposition. Here is how we map to what matters to you:

- **Genuine multi-day, point-to-point trekking.** Not day-walks from a hotel base — real remote traverses across the Jebel Dahar Berber highlands, the canyons and mountain oases of the Jebel en Negueb, and the dunes of the Grand Erg Oriental, sleeping in wild bivouacs and Berber guesthouses.
 - **Remote and off the beaten path.** Our terrain is the Tunisian deep south and interior ranges — ksour country, troglodyte villages, palm oases and open erg — far from the coastal resorts most visitors never leave.
 - **Fixed-departure-ready.** We build your trek as a costed, fixed-departure product with set dates, fixed group sizes and locked logistics — ready to publish in a German catalogue.
 - **Robust safety & support logistics.** Camel/4x4 baggage support, dedicated camp crew, scheduled water resupply, satellite comms and a documented evacuation protocol — the precise, reliable logistics the German small-group market expects.
 - **Vegan-friendly catering throughout.** Around 90% of meals are locally owned, and we cook **varied Tunisian plant-based dishes** — not eight days of plain couscous and vegetables. Liljana and any vegan travellers eat genuinely well.
 - **A local project your group can support.** Every expedition can be tied to a concrete, evidenced community or nature project that the group visits and contributes to directly (see below) — meaning, not greenwashing.
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WHY TREK TUNISIA

Tunisia packs an extraordinary trekking range into a compact, reliably-accessible country. Within a single expedition you can traverse the **Jebel Dahar** Berber highlands past fortified *ksour* and troglodyte villages, descend through the **mountain oases and canyons of Chebika, Tamerza and Midès** in the Jebel en Negueb, walk the shimmering edge of the **Chott el Jerid** salt lake, and then commit to a multi-day, camel-supported dune crossing of the **Grand Erg Oriental** near Douz, camping wild beneath the stars.

It is one of the most accessible and safe-feeling corners of North Africa for remote trekking: short approach transfers, warm Berber hospitality, dependable weather windows, and a cultural layering — Berber, Roman, Arab — that gives every walking day a story. For an operator whose travellers want long-distance, off-the-beaten-path adventure with real depth, Tunisia is a genuinely fresh fixed-departure proposition.

A LOCAL PROJECT YOUR EXPEDITION CAN SUPPORT

We believe support should be **fair, direct and evidenced** — the group visits the project, meets the people behind it, and contributes transparently. Choose one to anchor your fixed departures:

- **Berber village water, solar & school project (Jebel Dahar).** Support a highland village with clean-water access, solar lighting or a village school. The trek routes through the community for a half-day visit, and a per-traveller contribution funds an agreed, documented improvement.
- **Oasis palmeraie & foggara restoration.** Help restore traditional *foggara* irrigation channels and replant date palms in the mountain oases — directly sustaining the landscapes your group walks through. Travellers can join a planting or clearing session.
- **Anti-desertification reforestation near the oases.** Each departure funds and physically plants native, drought-tolerant trees at the desert margin, with photo-documented progress shared back to your travellers after the trip.
- **Women's artisan cooperative (weaving & pottery).** A visit and fair, direct purchase or commission supporting a Berber women's cooperative — meaning and authentic encounter on the same afternoon.

We supply an MOU, costings and evidence of fund use, so the project is a publishable, accountable part of your itinerary rather than an add-on.

Sahara & Jebel Dahar Expedition Trek — 8-9 days (fixed-departure)

Overview

A genuine point-to-point trekking expedition across the Tunisian deep south: from the fortified ksour and troglodyte villages of the **Jebel Dahar** Berber highlands, down across the **Chott el Jerid** salt-lake edge, and into a multi-day, camel-supported traverse of the **Grand Erg Oriental** dunes near Douz, finishing with wild desert bivouacs beneath the stars. Camel and 4x4 caravans carry baggage and resupply water; you carry a daypack. One full day is dedicated to visiting and supporting your chosen local project.

Key Information

Duration	8–9 days, point-to-point
Trekking grade	Moderate to challenging (some long dune and highland days)
Daily walking	4–7 hours / 12–22 km per trekking day
Terrain	Berber highland tracks, ksour ridgelines, salt-lake edge, open erg dunes
Support	Camel support caravan + 4x4 baggage/water resupply, camp crew, satellite comms, evacuation protocol
Accommodation	Berber guesthouses + wild desert bivouac camps
Catering	Full board; varied Tunisian vegan / plant-based menus throughout
Group	Small group, fixed departures

Highlights

- Point-to-point traverse of the Jebel Dahar highlands and ksour country
- Multi-day camel-supported crossing of the Grand Erg Oriental dunes
- Wild bivouac camps and starlit desert nights
- A dedicated project-visit day with a Berber community
- ONTT-certified guides, full camel/4x4 support and leave-no-trace camping

Day-by-Day Itinerary

Day 1: Arrival in Djerba & transfer to the Jebel Dahar

Arrival, welcome briefing and route/safety overview, then transfer inland to the Berber highlands. Short acclimatisation leg on foot (1–2 hours, easy tracks) to settle into the rhythm and meet your guides and camp crew.



Accommodation: Berber guesthouse · *Meals:* Dinner (vegan options)

Day 2: Ksour ridgeline trek — Jebel Dahar

First full trekking day along highland ridgelines linking fortified granaries and Berber villages (5–6 hours / 16 km, rocky tracks and gentle climbs). Sweeping views over the pre-desert plains.



Accommodation: Berber guesthouse · *Meals:* Breakfast, trail lunch, dinner (vegan)

Day 3: Troglodyte villages & escarpment descent

Trek through troglodyte-village country and down the escarpment (6 hours / 18 km, mixed descent and undulating tracks). Camel caravan carries baggage; first wild bivouac at the foot of the hills.



Accommodation: Wild bivouac camp · *Meals:* Breakfast, trail lunch, dinner (vegan)

Day 4: Project-visit day — Berber community

A slower day built around your chosen local project: a half-day visit to the Berber village water/solar/school project (or oasis foggara restoration), with time to meet residents, see the work and contribute. Short linking walk (2–3 hours) to the next camp.



Accommodation: Berber guesthouse · *Meals:* Breakfast, lunch, dinner (vegan)

Day 5: Salt-lake edge — Chott el Jerid

Transfer to the trailhead and trek along the shimmering margin of the Chott el Jerid salt lake (5 hours / 15 km, flat but exposed terrain). Surreal mirage country; 4x4 shadows the route with water resupply.



Accommodation: Wild bivouac camp · *Meals:* Breakfast, trail lunch, dinner (vegan)

Day 6: Into the Grand Erg Oriental

Begin the dune traverse from near Douz with the camel support caravan (5–6 hours / 14 km, soft sand, steady effort). Climb the first great dune lines and make camp deep in the erg.



Accommodation: Wild bivouac camp · *Meals:* Breakfast, trail lunch, dinner (vegan)

Day 7: Deep dune crossing

The committing heart of the expedition — a long dune day across the open erg (6–7 hours / 20 km, soft sand and dune crests), fully camel-supported. Starlit camp and Berber music around the fire.



Accommodation: Wild bivouac camp · *Meals:* Breakfast, trail lunch, dinner (vegan)

Day 8: Final dunes & desert exit

A final morning of dune trekking to the erg edge (4 hours / 12 km), where the 4x4 caravan meets the group. Celebratory last desert camp or transfer toward Djerba depending on dates.



Accommodation: Desert camp · *Meals:* Breakfast, trail lunch, dinner (vegan)

Day 9: Transfer & departure

Transfer to Djerba for departure (or optional rest/extension day). Debrief, group photos and shared project-impact summary.



Accommodation: — · *Meals:* Breakfast

Walking Tunisia — Coast, Oases & Berber Trails — 8 days

Overview

A varied, moderate walking expedition linking the **mountain oases and canyons of Chebika, Tamerza and Midès**, the Berber highlands of the Jebel Dahar, and a taste of the desert edge — a gentler complement to the flagship trek, ideal as a second fixed-departure tier or a softer-graded departure. Camel/4x4 support carries baggage on the wilder sections; nights blend Berber guesthouses with a desert camp.

Key Information

Duration	8 days
Trekking grade	Easy to moderate
Daily walking	3–5 hours / 10–16 km per walking day
Terrain	Canyon and oasis paths, Berber highland tracks, dune edge
Support	4x4 baggage support, camel support on desert legs, camp crew, satellite comms
Accommodation	Berber guesthouses + one desert camp
Catering	Full board; varied Tunisian vegan / plant-based menus throughout
Group	Small group, fixed departures

Highlights

- Canyon and waterfall walking at Tamerza, Chebika and Midès
- Mountain-oasis palmeraie trails
- Berber highland villages and ksour
- A short camel-supported desert-edge bivouac
- Fully supported, leave-no-trace walking

Day-by-Day Itinerary

Day 1: Arrival in Djerba

Arrival, welcome and route briefing, gear check and an easy orientation stroll. Meet your guide and review the week ahead.



Accommodation: Guesthouse · *Meals:* Dinner (vegan options)

Day 2: Jebel Dahar Berber trails

Transfer to the highlands and walk between Berber villages and ksour (4 hours / 13 km, gentle rocky tracks). Introduction to troglodyte architecture and highland life.



Accommodation: Berber guesthouse · *Meals:* Breakfast, trail lunch, dinner (vegan)

Day 3: Ksour country walk

A scenic linking walk past fortified granaries and ridgeline viewpoints (4–5 hours / 15 km, undulating). Time to explore a restored ksar.



Accommodation: Berber guesthouse · *Meals:* Breakfast, trail lunch, dinner (vegan)

Day 4: Mountain oasis trek

Transfer west and trek into the mountain oases, walking palmeraie paths between springs and terraces (4 hours / 12 km, shaded oasis trails).



Accommodation: Guesthouse · *Meals:* Breakfast, trail lunch, dinner (vegan)

Day 5: Canyon trek — Midès & Tamerza

A spectacular canyon walking day through the gorges of Midès and Tamerza (5 hours / 14 km, canyon paths and gentle scrambles).



Accommodation: Guesthouse · *Meals:* Breakfast, trail lunch, dinner (vegan)

Day 6: Oasis pools & palmeraie

A lighter day on oasis trails with time at natural pools and palm groves (3 hours / 10 km, easy). A visit to a women's artisan cooperative supports the local economy.



Accommodation: Guesthouse · *Meals:* Breakfast, lunch, dinner (vegan)

Day 7: Desert-edge camel bivouac

Transfer toward Douz and a short camel-supported walk into the dunes (3–4 hours / 11 km, soft sand) to a desert camp for a starlit night.



Accommodation: Desert camp · *Meals:* Breakfast, trail lunch, dinner (vegan)

Day 8: Return & departure

Morning dune stroll, then transfer to Djerba for departure. Debrief and farewells.



Accommodation: — · Meals: Breakfast

RESPONSIBLE & LEAVE-NO-TRACE TREKKING

Responsible travel is built into how we walk, not bolted on afterwards:

- **Locally owned and fairly paid.** Around **95% of accommodation** and **90% of meals** are locally owned; Berber hosts, guides and porters are paid **fairly and directly**.
- **Genuinely good vegan catering.** Varied Tunisian plant-based dishes — not eight days of plain couscous and vegetables.
- **Leave no trace.** We pack out all waste from wild camps, use **reusable water systems** with planned resupply rather than single-use plastic, and tread lightly on fragile dune and oasis environments.
- **Carbon-aware.** We track **CO₂e per night** and are **eCollective-ready** for your reporting.
- **Animal welfare.** Camel support animals are **ABTA-aligned welfare** standard — well cared for, fairly loaded and rested.
- **Real local support.** Your chosen community/nature project is funded directly and transparently, with evidence shared back to travellers.

PRICING

Illustrative net rates. Figures below are indicative, land-only net per person and will be confirmed against your chosen dates, group size, project and service tier.

Expedition	Days	Group size	Indicative net pp (land-only)
Sahara & Jebel Dahar Expedition Trek	8–9	Larger small group	~€1,000–1,300
Sahara & Jebel Dahar Expedition Trek	8–9	Smaller group	~€1,500–1,900
Walking Tunisia — Coast, Oases & Berber Trails	8	Small group	~€1,000–1,700

Rates are **land-only net**, with **no compulsory single supplement**. Project contributions can be itemised separately or built into the per-traveller price. **Costed reply within 72 hours.**

LET'S PUT TUNISIA ON YOUR DEPARTURE BOARD

Liljana — thank you for considering Depart Travel Services for ExpeditionXplore's Tunisia programme. We would love to build you a fixed-departure desert-and-highland trek that your travellers remember for the meaning as much as the miles. Concrete next steps:

1. **Joint recce & route GPX.** We host you on the ground, walk the flagship route and hand over full **GPX tracks**, daily distances and waypoint notes.
2. **Fixed-departure dates.** We agree a set of publishable 2026/2027 departure dates, group sizes and locked logistics for your catalogue.
3. **Project MOU.** We confirm your chosen community/nature project with a signed **MOU**, costings and an evidence-of-impact framework.
4. **Costed proposal.** A full, fixed-departure-ready costing — within 72 hours of your brief.

Contact

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🕒 A costed response within 72 hours — guaranteed.